

CHENG Zheng

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 **Research Interests:** Construction Grammar, Psycholinguistics, Language Acquisition, Language Comprehension,

EDUCATION

2024.09-2027.06 **Sichuan International Studies University** **Master of Language Intelligence**

GPA: 4.72/5.0 (ranking top 5%)

Coursework: Psycholinguistics, Fundamentals of Intelligent Language, Adult Language Cognitive Disorder, Statistics in Language Intelligence, Natural Language Processing, Construction Grammar, Corpus Linguistics,

2020.09-2024.06 **Hubei University of Science and Technology** **Bachelor of English Translation and Interpretation**

GPA: 3.25/4.0 (ranking top 5%)

Coursework: Introduction to Linguistics, Introduction to Translation, Fundamental Interpreting, Liaison Interpreting.

Research Experience

Research Assistant, *Computational Stylometry Project*

Jan, 2026 – Present

Supervised by Prof. Shuqin Jiang, Sichuan International Studies University

- Designed and implemented a computational stylometric analysis pipeline comparing translational styles in Chinese literary texts, integrating lexical diversity, clause length, syntactic complexity, and readability metrics.
- Developed a bespoke 14-dimensional syntactic-complexity framework for Chinese by adapting published methodologies, automating feature extraction where no existing NLP tool was available — filling a measurable methodological gap in Chinese computational stylometry.

Research Assistant

Aug, 2025 – Present

Research Group of Prof. Yu (Adam) Deng, Sichuan International Studies University

- Contribute across the full research cycle of studies spanning construction grammar, event cognition, and language pathology: synthesize literature, draft experimental materials, and revise research protocols.
- Coordinate participants and manage data collection and preprocessing for behavioral and EEG experiments with adult, child, and elderly populations, performing preliminary statistical analyses (R) that directly feed primary investigators' models.
- Support AI-based mining and modeling of discourse data from special populations, bridging language-intelligence methods with clinical language research.
- Streamline project management and dissemination — documentation, team meetings, research seminars and training — ensuring studies progress on schedule.

Lead Researcher, *Structural Priming in Mandarin Constructions*

Feb. 2025 – Dec. 2025

Sichuan International Studies University

- Led the full study lifecycle: designed a maze self-paced reading experiment and recruited and ran 160 participants to measure online processing of Mandarin *ba*-constructions.
- Conducted quantitative analyses in R with linear mixed-effects models (LMMs), identifying interaction effects between construction types that support the constructional-network hypothesis.
- Authored the first-author manuscript detailing rationale, methodology, and findings — currently under review at *Review of Cognitive Linguistics*.

Research Assistant, Project: *Cross-linguistic Variability in Event Encoding*

Feb. 2025 – Jun. 2025

University of Cambridge | Faculty of Asian and Middle Eastern Studies

Supervisor: Dr. Alimujiang Tusun

- Executed a behavioral study on language-cognition relations, screening and recruiting 40 monolingual Mandarin speakers to control for linguistic background.
- Solely delivered all 40 video-recorded production sessions (~30 min each), producing 20 hours of primary verbal data for team analysis.
- Processed 40 written questionnaires, including verbatim transcription and linguistic annotation, preparing the dataset for subsequent team-level analysis.

South China University of Technology | Guangdong Province Graduate Summer School

- Acquired hands-on experience operating eye-tracking apparatus and designing experimental setups through an intensive one-week program focused on language process research.
- Developed a foundational understanding of utilizing eye-tracking metrics to investigate cognitive and linguistic processing during translation tasks.

► Publications & Academic Output

Conference Presentations

- **Cheng, Z.** (2025, May 10-11). [*Does a Caused-Motion Construction Facilitate a Resultative? A Structural Priming Study*]. Oral presentation at the 7th International Conference on (Talmyan) Cognitive Semantics, Kaifeng, China.

Conference Posters

- **Cheng, Z., & Deng, Y.** (2025, December 12-14). *Does a Caused-Motion Construction Facilitate a Resultative? Evidence from a Structural Priming Study within the Mandarin bǎ-Construction*. Poster presented at the 19th International Conference on East Asian Psycholinguistics (ICPEAL), Guangzhou, China.
- **Cheng, Z., & Deng, Y.** (2025, July). *Prototype Effects and Gradience in the Constructional Network: Structural Priming Evidence from Caused-Motion and Resultative Sentences in Mandarin bǎ-Construction*. Poster presented at the 14th International Conference on Construction Grammar (ICCG-14), Princeton, NJ, USA.

Manuscripts

- **Cheng, Z., & Deng, Y.** (Under Review). *Prototype Effects and Gradience in the Constructional Network: Structural Priming Evidence from Caused-Motion and Resultative Sentences in Mandarin bǎ-Construction*. Review of Cognitive Linguistics.
- **Yang, S., & Cheng, Z.** (Under Review). *The entrenchment-and-conventionalization mechanism of near-synonymous construction divergence: A collostructional and dynamic semantic space analysis of Chabuduo V and Chadian V*. Cognitive Linguistics.
- **Cheng, Z., Yang, Y., & Deng, Y.** (Manuscript). *The Continuum and Gradience in the Constructional Network of Modern Mandarin bǎ-Constructions: Evidence from Multi-Space Representations of Caused-Motion and Resultative Constructions*.
- **Cheng, Z., Luo, X., & Deng, Y.** (Manuscript). *From Victim Narratives to Radicalization: A Critical Discourse Analysis of Incel Online Discourse Using Deep Learning*.

► Dissertation

Master’s Thesis

Investigating the Cognitive Mechanisms of the Chinese bǎ-Construction Network: Converging Evidence from Syntactic Priming and Distributional Semantics Analysis of Caused-Motion and Resultative Constructions

Sichuan International Studies University | Supervised by Prof. Yu (Adam) Deng

- A multi-method thesis validating the constructional network hypothesis for Mandarin, converging behavioral and computational evidence on caused-motion and resultative constructions.
- Study 1 (Behavioral): Designed and executed a syntactic priming experiment using a maze task, collecting and analyzing reaction time data from 160 participants. Findings provide online processing evidence for the network. (This study constitutes a manuscript currently under review at *Review of Cognitive Linguistics*).
- Study 2 (Computational): Embedding-based (BERT) analysis of target constructions on a balanced corpus, quantifying their semantic–syntactic proximity as distributional evidence complementary to Study 1.

► Skills

Technical & Research Skills

- **Programming & Analysis:** Proficient in R and Python for statistical modeling and computational linguistics. Experienced in designing behavioral experiments with PsychoPy and Ibex Farm.
- **Machine Learning:** Skilled in fine-tuning pre-trained models (e.g., BERT) and applying semi-supervised/unsupervised learning methods to NLP research.
- **Methodologies:** Familiar with experimental psycholinguistics data collection protocols and quantitative corpus-based research methods.

► Honors & Awards

Professional Qualifications

- **Test for English Majors (TEM):** Band 4 (Good) & Band 8 (Good)
- **CATTI (China Accreditation Test for Translators and Interpreters):** Level III Translation Certificate

Academic Honors

- **Graduate First-Class Scholarship**, Sichuan International Studies University (Amount/Range, e.g., top 5%)
- **Graduate Thesis Competition, Third Prize, Sichuan International Studies University**
 - **Thesis:** A Comparative Study of Linguistic Features in Depression and Psychosis from the Perspective of Mental State Words and Image Schemas